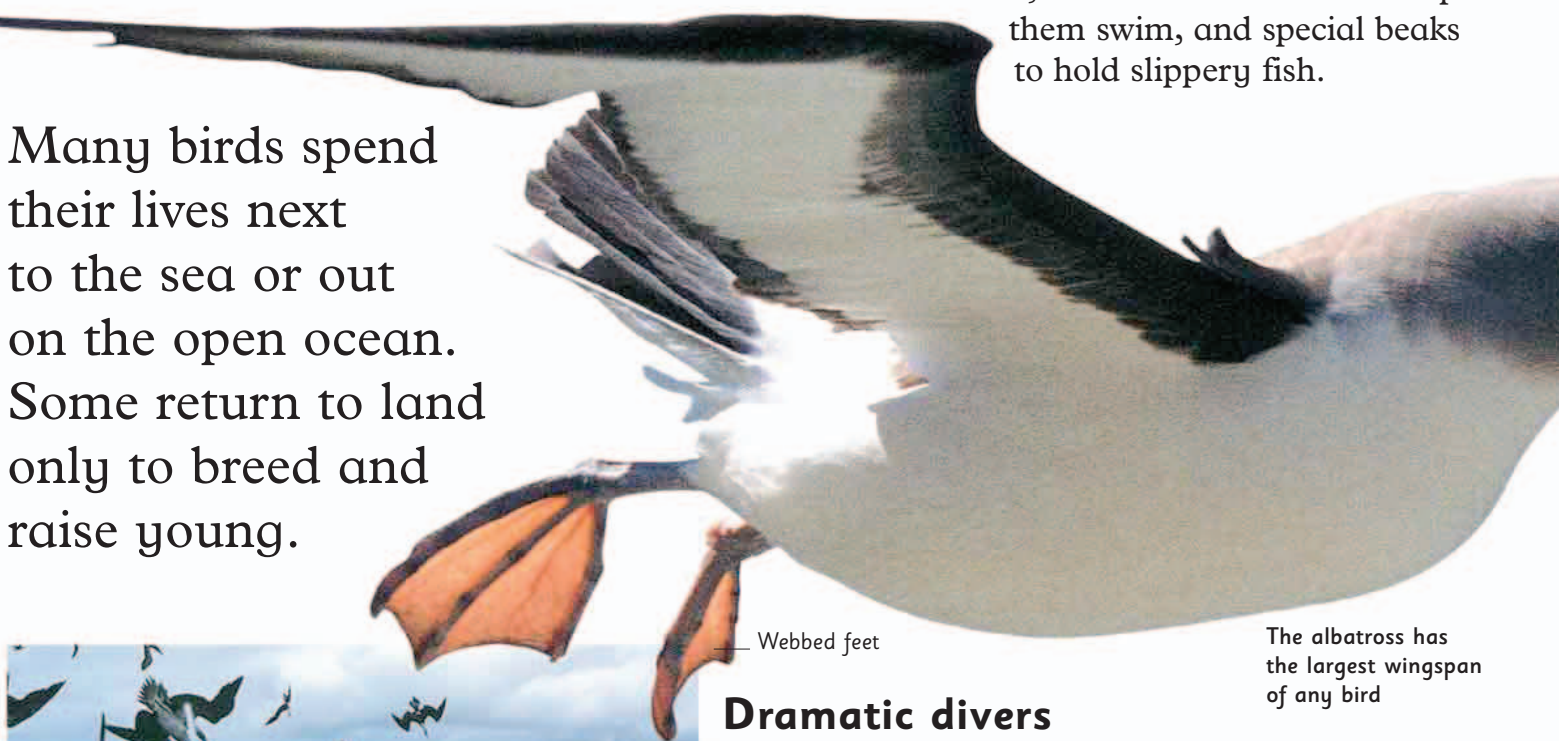


Sea birds

Many birds spend their lives next to the sea or out on the open ocean. Some return to land only to breed and raise young.

A life at sea

A lot of sea birds, such as this albatross, have webbed feet that help them swim, and special beaks to hold slippery fish.



Webbed feet

The albatross has the largest wingspan of any bird

Dramatic divers

The sea is full of prey and birds have various ways to catch it. Some chase fish underwater while others, such as gannets and boobies, dive down like torpedoes from the air to snatch them.



Other sea birds

The coastlines of the world are always packed with sea birds.



Herring gull: this bird is common in Europe and North America.



Inca tern: this bright-beaked bird lives on the west coast of South America.



Cormorant: this bird can also be found inland in Europe, Asia, and Africa.

Pelican



Pelicans also use their large mouths to catch rainwater for drinking.



A mouthful of fish

A pelican dives underwater and scoops up fish in its large mouth. It can fit three times more fish in its mouth pouch than in its stomach!